

BABS1201 Science Communication Project Instructions

Due Date and Weighting

- This assessment is weighted as **25%** of your total mark.
- The project is comprised of three components: a visual abstract (10%), a presentation (10%) and question time (5%).
- The visual abstract is **due prior to your enrolled laboratory class in Week 9** via the Turnitin link on Moodle.
- The verbal presentation of your visual abstract and question time will take place **during your enrolled laboratory class in Week 9**.
- When submitting the visual abstract via Turnitin, ensure you check the name of your file before uploading so that you upload the correct file. You should also check that you receive a receipt of submission, and you can click on your submission to see that it is displaying correctly for your marker.
- Note that if you try to upload just before the deadline, you may be delayed due to the number of students in the course and submit late.

Instructions

- The Science Communication Project uses the same topic you chose for your literature review. This will be the topic of both components, the visual abstract and the presentation in your Week 9 laboratory class.
- **Visual abstract (10%):**
 - Requires you to summarise and clearly communicate the key concepts of your Literature Review using a visual representation (a static infographic). You can use a combination of images, icons, and concise text annotations to effectively communicate the main points of your review. This visual summary should support your verbal presentation.
 - Your visual abstract should be one static image, i.e., you cannot have your information over multiple sides.
 - Your visual abstract should contain a title and sufficient text for the audience to follow. You must submit your visual abstract (the infographic) along with a separate page containing the text portions of your abstract and the reference list. This text should be uploaded as a PDF from a text editor, such as Word, to ensure it can be read by Turnitin and viewed by your marker without specialised software. You do NOT need to submit your presentation speech, only the text from your visual abstract.
 - You should submit your visual abstract via the Turnitin submission link in the Assessments section of Moodle prior to your presentation in Week 9 AND bring a physical or electronic copy of the abstract with you for the presentation.
- **Verbal presentation (10%):**
 - You will deliver a 3-minute overview of your Literature Review or a key aspect of it as outlined by your visual abstract.
 - Ensure your visual abstract clearly outlines your presentation.
 - Your verbal presentation will be marked by your demonstrator in class.
 - Your visual abstract will be marked either in class or following the class.
- **A brief Q&A session will follow your presentation (5%)** where you will be asked questions on your presentation and you are expected to ask questions to other presenters.

Criteria: Visual Abstract

Your visual abstract will be assessed on the following criteria, these are included in the marking rubric.

1. **Organisation and audience.** The visual abstract should communicate the key concepts of the mini literature review to a BABS1201 student audience. The audience should easily be able to understand the main concepts of your review without external explanation. The visual abstract should feature an informative title, and a logical flow and organisation of information.
2. **Content and effectiveness of communication.** Ensuring that your visual abstract gives an overview of the key elements of the mini literature review, as would a written abstract. You can include some text in your abstract, but it should supplement the visual aspects only. You should communicate the main points without overwhelming the viewer with excessive text.
3. **Communicates topic visually.** Composition of the visual abstract needs to contain visually appealing design elements such as colour, layout, fonts, etc. to engage the viewer. Ensure that the use of images, graphs, or icons enhances understanding without introducing unnecessary complexity, resulting in a visually engaging abstract that is a concise summary of your topic.
4. **References.** Ensure that your abstract includes the relevant reference/s and that they are cited correctly in the Harvard style. The in-text references should appear on the abstract, and your reference list should be submitted on the same page as the transcript directly into Turnitin.

Criteria- Verbal Presentation

Your verbal presentation will be assessed on the following criteria, these are included in the marking rubric.

1. **Content and Clarity:** Content and clarity are fundamental aspects of your presentation. Clearly articulating the key concepts of your mini literature review, ensuring logical organisation, and tailoring the message for a BABS1201 student audience are essential. A well-structured and comprehensible presentation fosters understanding and engagement, enhancing the overall effectiveness of your communication.
2. **Engagement and Delivery:** Your presentation should keep the audience's attention for three minutes and clearly articulate your content. You will need to speak audibly, with an appropriate pace and varied tone, expressing enthusiasm for the subject matter, contributing to a compelling and impactful delivery that captivates the audience. You will use your visual abstract as a visual aid to support your talk.
3. **Integrates Visual Representation:** Interacting with your visual abstract during the talk is important for a dynamic presentation. You should actively refer to and engage with your visual abstract throughout your verbal presentation to reinforce key concepts and ensure a more engaging experience for the audience.
4. **Time management:** You have a maximum of three (3) minutes for your presentation. Effective time management is crucial during the presentation to ensure that you adhere to the 3-minute limit, allowing you to cover all essential points concisely and maintain the engagement of your audience. You will be stopped at three (3) minutes.
5. **Questions:** You should be well-prepared to answer questions as it demonstrates your depth of knowledge, enhances the credibility of your presentation, and ensures you can engage confidently with the audience, contributing to a more comprehensive understanding of your mini literature review. You are also expected to engage in asking questions to other presenters.

Academic Honesty and Plagiarism

Referencing is a way of acknowledging the sources of information used in your assignments. You need to provide a reference whenever you draw on someone else's words, ideas or research. Not referencing other people's work can constitute plagiarism.

Further information about referencing styles can be located at

<https://student.unsw.edu.au/referencing>

Academic integrity is fundamental to success at university. Academic integrity can be defined as a commitment to six fundamental values in academic pursuits: honesty, trust, fairness, respect, responsibility and courage. At UNSW, this means that your work must be your own, and others' ideas should be appropriately acknowledged. If you don't follow these rules, plagiarism may be detected in your work.

Further information about academic integrity, plagiarism and the use of AI in assessments can be located at:

- The [Current Students site](#),
- The [ELISE training site](#), and
- The [Use of AI for assessments](#) site.

The Student Conduct and Integrity Unit provides further resources to assist you to understand your conduct obligations as a student: <https://student.unsw.edu.au/conduct>

Generative AI

You can use generative AI software in this assessment for assistance in summarising your journal articles from the more technical language used in scientific literature. This may assist you in seeing how scientific literature can be communicated in simpler language suitable for a different audience. Any output of generative software within your assessment must be attributed with full referencing.

If the outputs of generative AI such as ChatGPT form part of your submission and is not appropriately attributed, it will be regarded as serious academic misconduct and subject to the standard penalties, which may include 00FL, suspension and exclusion.

* To cite: OpenAI (Year Accessed). ChatGPT. OpenAI. <https://openai.com/models/chatgpt/>

* Please note that the outputs from these tools are not always accurate, appropriate, nor properly referenced. You should ensure that you have moderated and critically evaluated the outputs from generative AI tools such as ChatGPT before submission and keep a record of this for if you are required to show the process you used.

Learning Outcomes

- The Science Communication Project assessed CLO 1: Effectively communicate scientific findings to different audiences using different methods.
- It also aligns with the Australian Council of Deans of Science Threshold Learning Outcomes (2023) 4. Be effective communicators of science by:
 - 4.1. communicating scientific results, information, or arguments with a range of audiences, for a range of purposes, and using a variety of modes
 - 4.2. promoting the role and value of science in addressing current challenges facing local and global communities.

Resources provided

Resources provided to help you with this assessment include:

- The 'Scientific Communication 2' lecture.
- The BABS1201 Presentation rubric on Moodle.

Frequently Asked Questions

What if I am absent for the Week 9 Presentation lab?

You need to apply for Special Consideration. For all of the information on when and how to apply for Special Consideration please see the Course Outline and access via

<https://www.student.unsw.edu.au/special-consideration>.

Can I bring in my visual abstract on the morning of my lab and store it for the day?

No. If you choose to bring a printed copy of your visual abstract you will need to bring it with you and take it when you leave. Unfortunately, we do not have the capacity to store any visual abstracts.

I still don't really know what a visual abstract is, where can I go for more information on this?

You should rewatch the Science Communication lecture which covers this in detail or alternatively ask your demonstrator or a convenor in class.

How do I reference my visual abstract?

You will need to use in-text referencing on your visual abstract. Usually, the full reference is also provided on the visual abstract, however, as this assessment requires multiple references, we would like you to provide a reference list in your visual abstract submission document alongside the transcript.

Do I need to submit a transcript of my verbal presentation?

No, you only need to submit the text from your visual abstract. This is because Turnitin may not be able to read the text in your visual abstract, so by placing it on a separate page in written form we can ensure Turnitin can read it.

Can I use additional slides in my presentation?

No, we are limiting the visual aid to only your visual abstract, which should consist of a static infographic.

Can I use palm cards or notes for my presentation?

Yes, you can use palm cards or notes for your presentation. However, it's important to use them as a reference rather than reading directly from them, so you can maintain eye contact and engage effectively with your audience.

I have used Canva or Biorender to create images for my visual abstract, do I need to reference these images?

When using images from platforms like Canva or Biorender, you do not need to include an in-text citation, rather referencing these platforms in your reference list (like what you would do for Generative AI) is sufficient as they don't require individual image attributions.

Need more help?

Ask questions on the Moodle forum, in your laboratory class and in the live Q&A sessions.